



### Xiaomi Mi 11 Pro Design Leak

Leaked poster reveals new design with quad camera, offering 120x digital zoom and periscope lens. <http://dgit.in/feb21-65>



### Motorola Edge S

World's first smartphone to be powered by a Snapdragon 870 SoC has officially launched in China. <http://dgit.in/feb21-66>

# Mi 10i

## Democratising expensive features

**X**iaomi is kicking off the year 2021 strong with the launch of the Mi 10i. The phone comes in squarely in the mid-range segment bringing with it a number of features usually found only in more expensive devices like a 108MP primary camera, a 120Hz refresh rate display and IP53 rating. Does on-paper numbers make for a value for money device? We have the answers.

### Display

The Mi 10i sports a 6.67-inch IPS-LCD panel with a refresh rate of a whopping 120Hz. To make it more lucrative for gamers, Xiaomi's using a panel with a 240Hz polling rate.

The panel comes with an HDR10+ certification, but at the time of writing this review, Netflix didn't recognize the phone as HDR-compliant, although YouTube HDR worked just fine.

The peak brightness as tested by us capped out at 350 nits, which is definitely on the lower side, especially for a display that has an HDR10+ certification. However, the lower-than-competition peak brightness isn't the real problem, it's reflections. The panel is rather reflective and unless you're looking directly at it, you're going to have legibility issues.

### Camera performance

The star-feature of the Mi 10i is the 108 megapixel primary camera. The results are sufficiently impressive. The colours and dynamic range are comparable to the binned result, a surprising feat. However, the larger resolution file has lesser sharpness in comparison to the binned file. Additionally, when shooting in the 108 Megapixel mode, the AF slows down noticeably and



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the time between two shots increases by up to 4 seconds.

The ultra-wide camera on the Mi 10i is above average, offering decent sharpness in the center with a noticeable fall-off towards the edges. The lens also shows noticeable distortion, which is hard to control if your subject is close. The lack of auto focus makes creative framing impossible and you're limited to shooting subjects that are far away.

The Macro lens on the Mi 10i is surprisingly good, if you can ever manage to get the shot right. It allows you to get really close to the subject, but unfortunately, the closer you are to a subject, the more noticeable shake gets.

Shooting in low light in the normal camera mode yields under-exposed images with completely crushed shadows and contrast. Switch over to Night Mode, however, and the frame brightens up, allowing more details to be captured in the shadow area.

### Performance

The Mi 10i is powered by the new Qualcomm Snapdragon 750G chipset. With this, you get 2 performance cores going up to 2.2GHz and 6 efficiency cores that clock up to 1.8GHz. Our review unit comes with 8GB RAM,

although there is a cheaper 6GB variant available as well.

The OnePlus Nord mostly leads in performance for both CPU and GPU, faltering behind the Mi 10i only in a few tests. In real world usage however, the experience is a little different. While using the phone for normal day-to-day tasks is butter smooth, playing games like CoD Mobile on the Mi 10i was not as smooth as playing it on the Nord. While the OnePlus Nord had a 98 percent frame-rate stability at 60fps, the Mi 10i was only able to maintain a 73 percent stability of the same game, while delivering 58fps.

### Battery life

The excellent battery life on the Mi 10i is courtesy a 4820mAh battery which supports a modest 33W fast charging. One episode of watching Altered Carbon being streamed via Netflix cost only 8 percent battery (started at 100 percent) while one round of CoD Mobile cost only 6 percent battery (started at 80 percent). The phone easily lasts one full day of excessive use. Xiaomi's 33-watt fast charging is also very helpful in topping off the battery quickly, going from 0 to 50 percent in about 35 minutes while a full top up takes only 58 minutes.

### Verdict

The Mi 10i is a surprisingly good balance between performance and imaging. The Mi 10i checks off a whole lot of boxes and we do hope that Xiaomi will continue to improve the performance of the SoC and the camera via updates.

—Swapnil Mathur

### SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: Qualcomm Snapdragon 750G (8nm), octa-core processor, up to 2.2 GHz | GPU: Adreno 619 | 5G: X52 5G modem | DISPLAY: 120Hz 6.67" 25D DotDisplay | DISPLAY RESOLUTION: 2400 x 1080 FHD+ | STORAGE AND RAM: 6GB+128GB, 8GB+128GB | REAR CAMERA: 108MP+8MP+2MP+2MP quad rear camera | REAR CAMERA VIDEO: 1080p at 30/60 fps, 4K at 30fps, 720p at 30 fps | FRONT CAMERA: 16MP, 1080p video at 30fps, 720p video at 120fps | BATTERY AND CHARGING: 4820 mAh; 33W fast charging

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